

Stellar High School – Group Policy Implementation

Objective

Simulate a real-world school IT environment using Active Directory, Group Policy Objects (GPOs), and proper file access control.

Focus: Create separate environments for Students and Teachers with specific desktop policies.

Step 1: Create Organizational Units

In Active Directory Users and Computers (ADUC):

- Created two OUs:

stellar.local

└── Students

└── Teachers

Step 2: Create Security Groups

- Global Security Groups:

- Stellar_Students

- Stellar_Teachers

- Purpose:

- Use for file share permissions and future GPO filtering.

- Added relevant user accounts to each group.

Step 3: Create User Accounts

- Created test users:

- Student user → placed in Students OU.

- Teacher user → placed in Teachers OU.

- Each account linked to its respective security group.

Step 4: Prepare Wallpaper Folder

On DC:

- Created folder:

C:\Shared\Wallpaper

- Added two wallpaper images:

- student.jpg
- teacher.jpg

Shared Folder Configuration

- Share permissions:
 - Stellar_Students → Read
 - Stellar_Teachers → Read
- NTFS permissions:
 - Same groups → Read & Execute, List folder contents, Read

Step 5: Configure GPO for Teachers

In Group Policy Management:

- Created GPO: TeachersWallpaper
- Linked to Teachers OU.
- Edited:
 - User Configuration → Administrative Templates → Desktop → Desktop Wallpaper
 - Enabled
 - Wallpaper path: \\DC1\Wallpaper\teacher.jpg
 - Style: Fill
- Added policy:
 - User Configuration → Administrative Templates → Control Panel → Personalization → Prevent changing desktop background → Enabled

Step 6: Configure GPO for Students

- Same as above, but linked to Students OU and used:
 - <\\DC1\Wallpaper\student.jpg>
- User Configuration → Administrative Templates → Control Panel → *Prohibit access to Control Panel and PC settings* → **Enabled**

Step 7: Verify Policy Application

On client machines:

- Ran:
 - gpupdate /force
 - gpresult /r
- Confirmed:
 - TeachersWallpaper GPO applied to teacher user.
 - StudentsWallpaper GPO applied to student user.
- Checked wallpaper enforced correctly.
- Tested folder access:

\\DC1\Wallpaper

Accessible by both groups as per design.

Result

- Teachers and Students have:
 - Different wallpapers enforced by GPO.
 - Blocked ability to change wallpapers (Windows activation required to visually test this).
- Folder permissions work using security groups.
- Full OU + GPO + Security Group + Share Permissions structure implemented successfully.

Screenshots for Portfolio

1. OU and Security Group structure (ADUC screenshot)
2. GPO settings (Desktop Wallpaper policy enabled)
3. Wallpaper folder permissions (Share + NTFS)
4. gpresult /r output confirming GPO applied
5. Client desktop with wallpaper applied

Next Steps

- Configure StudentShare and TeacherShare network folders.
- Map drives using GPO Preferences.
- Deploy printer via GPO.
- Optional: Implement Login Scripts for extra automation.